

Κράτης ὁ Θηβαῖος

Crates of Thebes and the Cynic Letters on Philosophy

eul_aid: gwc

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Κοινή](#) [Koine](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Ἐπιστολή](#) [Epistle](#)
Affiliation: [Cynic](#)

Crates of Thebes was a Greek philosopher of the late 4th century BCE. A principal member of the Cynic school, he was a direct pupil of its most famous figure, Diogenes of Sinope. Born into a wealthy Theban family, Crates famously renounced his fortune to live a life of deliberate poverty and simplicity, embodying core Cynic ideals.

His historical importance is twofold. First, he served as a crucial link between Cynicism and Stoicism by being the teacher of Zeno of Citium, the founder of the Stoic school. This connection allowed core Cynic concepts to influence early Stoic ethics. Second, his life became a model for Cynic practice. He was known in Athens for his cheerful, benevolent character and for his philosophical marriage to Hipparchia of Maroneia. Their partnership was presented in ancient sources as a shared, ascetic life dedicated to philosophy.

Crates's own writings do not survive intact, but fragments remain. He is credited with composing philosophical letters, poems, and parodies of famous verse. These fragments provide valuable insight into how the Cynics used humor and satire as tools for philosophical critique.

Works (1)

- [Ἐπιστολαὶ περὶ Φιλοσοφίας](#) · [Cynic Letters on Philosophy](#) · 43 passages

Other Cynic Authors

- [Ἀντισθένης ὁ Ἀθηναῖος](#) · [Antisthenes of Athens I](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀντισθένης ὁ Ἀθηναῖος](#) · [Antisthenes of Athens II](#) · 2 works
- [Βίων ὁ Βορυσθενίτης](#) · [Bion of Borysthenes](#) · 2 works
- [Δημώναξ ὁ Κύπριος](#) · [Demonax of Cyprus](#) · 1 work
- [Διογένης ὁ Σινωπεύς](#) · [Diogenes of Sinope](#) · 1 work
- [Διοτογένης ὁ φιλόσοφος](#) · [Diotogenes the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Μόνιμος ὁ Συρακόσιος](#) · [Monimus of Syracuse](#) · 1 work
- [Οἰνόμαος ὁ Γαδαρεύς](#) · [Oenomaus of Gadara](#) · 1 work
- [Σεκούνδος ὁ Σιωπηλός](#) · [Secundus the Silent](#) · 2 works
- [Τέλης ὁ Μεγαρεύς](#) · [Teles of Megara](#) · 8 works